

Korea Exposure Constants

Middle East Daily Briefing

Standing reference for South Korea’s structural exposure to the Middle East, so daily briefs cite consistent baseline numbers instead of re-deriving them. Cite this file’s values with their as-of dates; when a brief finds a materially updated figure from a reliable source, update this table (and the PDF) and note the change in that day’s brief.

Last updated: July 17, 2026

Energy Import Dependence

Constant	Value	As of	Source / basis
Crude oil imports transiting Hormuz	~70% of total crude imports	Jul 2026	CSIS, Seoul Economic Daily
LNG imports from the Middle East	~36% (roughly one third)	Jul 2026	Seoul Economic Daily
Largest LNG supplier exposure	Qatar (Ras Laffan loadings)	Jul 2026	Brief 2026-07-14; Kpler via press
Helium from Qatar (semiconductor input)	~65% of Korean imports	Jul 2026	Brief 2026-07-14; compounded by China export halt

Crisis Mitigation Measures in Effect

Measure	Value	As of	Source / basis
Non-Hormuz crude secured (Kazakhstan, Oman, Saudi routes)	~273 million barrels, delivery through end 2026 (~3 months of consumption)	Jul 2026	Presidential chief of staff via Asharq Al-Awsat, OilPrice
Non-Hormuz naphtha secured	Up to 2.1 million tons	Apr 2026	Bloomberg
Naphtha export ban	In effect; naphtha designated an economic security item	Mar–Jul 2026	UPI, CSIS
Strategic reserve release	22.5 million barrels via IEA coordination	Jun–Jul 2026	CSIS
Strategic reserve coverage remaining	~26 days of actual consumption (estimate)	Jul 2026	CSIS; treat as estimate, Medium confidence
Supplementary budget	~\$17 billion passed	Jul 2026	CSIS
Refiners' joint task force	Four major refiners coordinating supply	Mar 2026	UPI
July–August crude procurement	100%+ of prior-year volume secured; MOTIE holding government reserve release in hand for further deterioration	Jul 2026	MOTIE emergency supply meeting via Asia Business Daily; S&P Global
Red Sea detour routing for crude	13 Korean tankers to date have routed crude via the Red Sea to avoid Hormuz; shipping companies advised against new Hormuz entries. NOTE: this workaround transits Bab el-Mandeb and is directly exposed to a Houthi closure	Jul 2026	MOTIE via Asia Business Daily; S&P Global
Nuclear restarts	Accelerated approvals	Jun 2026	CSIS

Corporate and Physical Exposure

Constant	Value	As of	Source / basis
Refiner ownership structure	SK Energy (domestic); S-Oil (Saudi Aramco majority ~63%); GS Caltex (Chevron 50% JV); HD Hyundai Oilbank (Aramco ~17% stake)	2026	Public filings; BISI. Three of four have US or Saudi ownership stakes, which constrains independent dealing with Iran
Barakah nuclear plant (UAE)	KEPCO-led consortium; 4 APR-1400 reactors (~5.6 GW); Korean staff on site; Korea's largest single overseas energy asset	2026	Public record
Korean nationals in the UAE	~10,000+ (estimate)	Jul 2026	Brief 2026-07-15; Low confidence, verify with MOFA figures
Korean nationals in other Gulf states	~1,000+ (estimate)	Jul 2026	Brief 2026-07-14; Low confidence, verify with MOFA figures
Construction/energy services backlog	Significant contracts in Kuwait, Bahrain, UAE, Saudi Arabia	Jul 2026	Briefs 2026-07-14/15; quantify when a reliable backlog figure appears

Financial Reference Points

Reference	Value	As of	Source / basis
Won first broke ₩1,500/USD	March 2026 (first time since 2009 crisis)	Mar 2026	Korea Times
Won crisis range since March	~₩1,490–1,530/USD	Mar–Jul 2026	KED Global, Businesskorea
KOSPI circuit breakers	7 triggered in 2026 through Jul 13 (Jul 13: -9.95% to 6,806.93)	Jul 2026	BigGo Finance, Korea Times
Monitoring thresholds in use	Won ₩1,500 line; Hormuz transits 20/day (binding) vs 30/day (recovery); Qatari LNG loadings -15% w/w	Jul 2026	Brief indicator series
BOK base rate	2.75% after +25bp on Jul 16, 2026 — first hike since Jan 2023, unanimous, further hikes signaled; statement cites Middle East oil and won weakness (June CPI 3.2%)	Jul 2026	BOK via Bloomberg, CNBC, Korea Herald

Maintenance rule: review this file monthly (or when a figure is contradicted by a Tier 1/2 source), update values and as-of dates, regenerate `korea-exposure.pdf`, and note the revision in that day's brief. Values marked "estimate" should be upgraded to official figures (MOFA, MOTIE, BOK, KNOC) when the network policy allows fetching them directly.